

ALCHEMIZE RESOURCE LIBRARY · BUSINESS FOUNDATION

Business Startup & Formation Workbook

A founder's launch workbook -- move from idea to ownership, registrations, money systems, and a 90-day plan.

USE THIS WORKBOOK TO

- ◆ Turn your idea into a clear, nameable business concept
- ◆ Know exactly who owns what and who can act for the business
- ◆ Map every registration, account, and system the business actually needs
- ◆ Leave with a written 30/60/90-day launch plan

ESTIMATED TIME

35-45 minutes, in one sitting or across a few working sessions

HAVE NEARBY

Any registration numbers you already have, a rough starting budget, a notepad for account logins

A durable business foundation is not only a good idea. It is a clear picture of what the business is, who it serves, what it needs to operate, and who controls the important records and decisions. This workbook walks that path in order.



01 BUSINESS CONCEPT CANVAS

START HERE

Use what you know today, even if some answers are a guess. A blank field is useful -- it tells you exactly what still needs to be decided before you can register or open an account.

Planning field	Current answer
Proposed legal name	
DBA / alternate name	
Product or service	
Target customer	
Primary business purpose	
State of formation / operating location	
Planned launch date	

What problem does this business solve, in one or two sentences?

Three names, three jobs

A landscaping business might register as "J. Alvarez Holdings LLC" (legal name), file "Bright Yard Landscaping" as its DBA, and market as "Bright Yard" (brand). Each can appear on different documents -- contracts, invoices, and social media.

The business model

A concept becomes a business when you can describe who pays, for what, and how the money actually moves. These two questions -- who is the customer, and how does revenue work -- shape almost every decision on the pages that follow.

01 IDEAL CUSTOMER SNAPSHOT

Question	Current answer
Who is most likely to buy?	
What problem are they trying to solve?	
How will they find the business?	
What makes this business easy to trust?	

02 OFFER AND REVENUE MAP

Revenue source	One-time / recurring / mixed	Typical payment method	Notes
Primary revenue source			
Secondary revenue source			
Typical transaction flow			
Customer follow-up process			

One-time versus recurring

A one-time sale earns a customer once; a recurring relationship earns them repeatedly for the same effort. Neither is automatically better -- but knowing which one you are building changes how you price, follow up, and measure success.

What would make a stranger choose this business over a nearby competitor?

LOOK FOR

A revenue model with no repeat customers and no referral path usually needs a bigger, more constant flow of new leads to stay steady. That is useful to know before you set a marketing budget.

Ownership and structure

Ownership, control, and decision-making matter early because they affect access, authority, tax treatment, and how complicated things become later. This page identifies who can do what before the business gets busy.

01 OWNERSHIP

Owner / member	Ownership %	Role	Decision authority	Initial contribution or responsibility

02 MANAGEMENT AND RESPONSIBILITY

Who handles day-to-day decisions and follow-up?

Who can sign agreements and make financial decisions?

Who manages records and recurring compliance?

Who can access banking, domains, software, and important accounts?

03 QUESTIONS THAT SHOULD BE CLEAR EARLY

- ☐ Who can enter agreements on behalf of the business?
- ☐ Who can approve payments or reimbursements?
- ☐ Who can hire contractors or employees?
- ☐ Who can access banking, domain, and software accounts?
- ☐ Who can approve major purchases or refunds?
- ☐ Who owns the operational follow-up when the founder is unavailable?

Professional review

Some ownership and legal decisions affect rights, taxes, liability, or formal authority. Use this workbook to identify the questions and the information each professional will need -- not to make the decision itself.

Registration and identity

This page organizes the administrative foundation that often gets postponed until after the business already has customers. The goal is to know what is required, where it lives, and who owns the follow-up.

01 REGISTRATION ROADMAP

WHY THIS MATTERS

Registrations tend to unlock each other in sequence. Knowing the order keeps you from opening a bank account or signing a lease before the business can legally do so.

Requirement to investigate	Agency / jurisdiction	Initial filing	Renewal frequency	Next due date	Owner
State formation filing					
EIN or tax registration					
DBA / assumed name					
Local or industry registration					
Licenses, permits, certificates					
Other jurisdictional requirement					

Formation is rarely the last step

Depending on the business, there may also be tax registrations, local requirements, insurance requirements, professional licensing, or industry-specific filings. Map the business's actual obligations, not just the first filing.

02 FORMATION AND IDENTITY RECORDS

- ☐ Approved formation documents and EIN confirmation
- ☐ Ownership or operating agreement, if applicable
- ☐ Registration confirmations, licenses, and permits
- ☐ Beneficial ownership, registered-agent, or tax-registration information
- ☐ Business email, domain, and contact records

Questions or requirements still to investigate

Registration records

Once a filing is approved, the confirmation itself becomes a permanent record. This page is where that paperwork gets a defined, findable home instead of scattering across inboxes and downloads folders.

01 WHERE FINAL RECORDS LIVE

Record category	Storage location	Backup location	Owner
Formation records			
Ownership / governance records			
Tax and financial records			
Insurance and risk records			

When in doubt, keep it

Storage is inexpensive; recreating a lost record is not. A well-organized archive folder is rarely a problem. A missing formation document or a lost tax filing usually is.

02 RETENTION QUICK REFERENCE

WHY THIS MATTERS

Retention rules vary by record type, jurisdiction, and circumstance. Use this as a starting checklist for the conversation with your accountant or attorney -- not as a final answer.

Record type	General guidance	Confirm with a professional
Formation and governance documents	Keep permanently	
Tax returns and supporting records	Keep several years, exact period varies	
Contracts and agreements	Keep through the relationship and after	
Insurance policies and claims	Keep the active policy and recent history	

Startup cost planning

Most surprises after launch are really planning gaps -- a cost nobody budgeted for, or a number that was never written down. Estimate each category before you spend, then come back and record what actually happened.

Cost category	Estimated cost	Actual cost	Notes
Formation and registration fees			
Licenses, permits, certificates			
Insurance (general, professional, other)			
Website, domain, and branding			
Equipment, inventory, or supplies			
Software and subscriptions			
Launch marketing			
Reserve buffer (unplanned costs)			

01 WHERE THE MONEY WILL COME FROM

Personal funds committed

Outside financing, loans, or investment, if any

What has to happen before that money is available?

Build in a buffer

A reserve line is not pessimism. Most first-year surprises are ordinary costs that simply were not on the original list -- a renewal fee, a reprint, a second round of supplies.

Money and customer systems

A business should not rely on memory or informal cash flow alone, and it should not make customers guess how to reach it, get a quote, or pay. This page is really one system in two halves: money in, and the experience that earns it.

01 BUSINESS MONEY RULES

- ☐ Business income has a defined destination
- ☐ Business purchases follow a defined payment process
- ☐ Receipts and source records have a defined storage location
- ☐ Owner contributions and reimbursements are easy to trace
- ☐ Deposits and invoice activity are reconciled to the business records
- ☐ Financial access is controlled by the business, not only by a person

02 MONEY FLOW MAP



03 CUSTOMER-FACING SYSTEMS

System	Current choice	Owner	Status	Follow-up
Website				
Domain and email				
Phone / contact path				
Scheduling / forms				
Quotes / estimates				
Payment / invoicing				

Owner activity should be traceable

Owner contributions, reimbursements, personal use, and mixed transactions should not disappear into general business history. A clear record helps later reviews and tax preparation.

Internal systems and access

A business can be well-intentioned and still hard to run if internal systems are disconnected or controlled by one person's personal account. This page finds where records live and where access is missing.

01 INTERNAL SYSTEMS

System	Current choice	Owner	Status	Follow-up
File storage				
Bookkeeping				
CRM or customer record system				
Project / task management				
Password and access management				
Backups				

02 BUSINESS OWNERSHIP TEST

For your most critical account right now, how confident are you that the business -- not just one person -- truly controls it?

Not confident

1	2	3	4	5
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Fully confident

For each critical account, ask:

☐	Is the business the account owner?
☐	Can more than one authorized person recover it?
☐	Is billing controlled by the business?
☐	Is MFA enabled where supported?
☐	Is the renewal date documented?
☐	Could the business continue if the current vendor, contractor, or owner disappeared?

03 CRITICAL ACCESS TRACKER

System	Recovery contact	Renewal date	Billing owner	Backup person

Launch readiness

The goal is not perfection on day one. The goal is clarity: what is working, what is missing, who must own it, and what should improve before the business gets busier.

01 READINESS DASHBOARD

Rate each area honestly using where it stands today, not where you hope it will be by launch.

Category	Not started	In progress	Ready	Professional review
Formation				
Finance and risk				
Operations and records				
Digital systems				
Customer experience				

Commonly overlooked

Domain ownership, renewal dates, expense separation, backup access, filing calendars, license renewal, and clear owner responsibilities are commonly missed until a problem appears.

02 WHAT TO FIX BEFORE YOUR FIRST CUSTOMER

Sort what is not yet ready

	Can wait	Blocks launch
Quick fix	Fix this week	Schedule a consult
Needs help	Note it, revisit later	Delegate or automate

- ☐ Customer inquiry pathway is clear
- ☐ Pricing or quote process is defined
- ☐ Agreement and payment process is in place
- ☐ Customer records have a defined home
- ☐ Follow-up responsibility is assigned

The first 90 days

Your output

By the end of this page, you should have three to five named actions for each 30-day block, each with a single owner and a real date -- not a wish list, a plan.

01 30 / 60 / 90-DAY PLAN

Timing	Priority action	Owner	Due date	Status
30 days				
30 days				
30 days				
60 days				
60 days				
90 days				
90 days				

02 WHAT WOULD MAKE THIS LAUNCH FEEL SUCCESSFUL?

In your own words, 90 days from now, what does "on track" look like?

NEXT STEP

YOU HAVE A PLAN. NOW BUILD THE FOUNDATION UNDER IT.

Need a second set of eyes on formation, registrations, or the money system before you launch? Schedule a consultation at getalchemize.com.

getalchemize.com

This workbook provides general organizational information, not legal, tax, accounting, licensing, or entity-selection advice. Requirements vary by jurisdiction and circumstance.